

Sivapithecus

SEE-vah-PITH-eck-uss

- **When** 12–7 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Nepal, Pakistan, Turkey
- **Habitat** Woodlands of Central Asia
- **Length** 5 ft (1.5 m)
- **Diet** Plants

This partial skull was rebuilt from broken pieces.

Large canine tooth

Sivapithecus had the build of a chimpanzee, but its face was more like that of an orangutan, to which it was closely related. It lived in woodland, but scientists think it may have spent much of its time on the ground. It had large molar teeth (rear teeth), suggesting its diet included a lot of tough food such as grass seed gathered on the ground, although it probably also climbed trees for fruit and may have slept in trees at night.

Dryopithecus

DRY-oh-PITH-eck-uss

- **When** 15–10 million years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** Africa, Europe, and Asia
- **Habitat** Woodlands of Europe, Asia, and Africa
- **Length** 2 ft (0.6 m)
- **Diet** Plants

▲ **LONG ARMS**
Dryopithecus used long arms to swing under branches like a gibbon.

Plesiadapis

PLEEZ-ee-ah-DAP-iss

- **When** 65–60 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Europe, and Asia
- **Habitat** Woodlands of N. America, Europe, and Asia
- **Length** 2 ft (0.6 m)
- **Diet** Plants

The oldest known primate is *Plesiadapis*, which looked more like a squirrel than a monkey. It had a bushy tail, a long snout, ratlike incisor teeth for gnawing, and eyes on

Gigantopithecus

gi-GAN-toe-PITH-eck-uss

- **When** 9 million–250,000 years ago (Neogene)
- **Fossil location** China, India, and Vietnam
- **Habitat** Woodlands of Asia
- **Length** 9 ft (2.7 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Twice the size of a gorilla, *Gigantopithecus* was the largest ape that ever lived—the King Kong of its day. Some scientists think it may be the source of the Yeti myth.

Only teeth and jaws have been found.

The pattern of wear suggests it fed on bamboo.

Lower jaw fossil

the sides of its head for spotting predators. However, the rear teeth of *Plesiadapis* were flat like those of living primates, suggesting its diet included fruit and other soft plant foods.

LIVING RELATIVE

Orangutans are the largest tree-dwelling mammals today. There are two species: the Bornean orangutan and the Sumatran orangutan. Both are highly intelligent, able to make and use simple tools. Both are also endangered, due to loss of their rainforest habitat.

Eosimias

EE-oh-SIM-ee-uss

- **When** 45–40 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** China
- **Habitat** Woodlands of Asia
- **Length** 2 in (5 cm)
- **Diet** Insects and plants

Eosimias was one of the earliest primates. Unlike the enormous mammals that evolved after the age of dinosaurs, *Eosimias* was like a tiny fur ball and would have easily fit into the palm of a child's hand. Its large eyes may have helped it to spot predators easily, especially at night. It probably fed on nectar and insects.